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SUPERSEDING
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

WASHCLOTH (DISPOSABLE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type and two sizes of disposable non-woven washcloths.

1.2 Classification

1.2.1 Sizes. The washcloths shall be of the following minimum sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1 - 10-3/4 inches by 11 inches.
Size 2 - 14-1/4 inches by 15 inches.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Wrapping.
PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple Wall.
PPP-B-1055 - Barrier Material, Waterproofed, Flexible.
PPP-T-76 - Tape Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive Paper, (For Carton Sealing)

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Standards:

T 403 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T 432 - Water Absorption of Bibulous Paper.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The material shall be nonwoven fabric consisting of fully bleached cellulose fibers, rayon fibers, or other synthetic fibers or mixtures thereof. All material shall be new and capable of being sterilized by steam without impairing the texture or function of the item.

3.2 Construction. The construction of the washcloth shall be such that the finished product will conform to the requirements of Table I when tested as specified in 4.3.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Characteristic	Requirement
Weight per square yard, ounces, minimum	1.5
Bursting strength, dry, pounds, minimum	25
Bursting strength, wet, pounds, minimum	11
Absorption, water	
Total, percent, minimum	300
Rate (0.1 milliliter) seconds, maximum	4
Blocking	No blocking

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3.3 Color and finish. The washcloth shall be white, a pastel color, or a mixture of either white and pastel colors or pastel colors. The washcloth shall feel soft to the skin and be free of any tendency to scratch the skin surface.

3.4 Odor. The washcloth shall not have any pronounced odor.

3.5 Workmanship. The finished washcloth shall be clean, free from breaks, tears, uneven or ragged edges and lint. Washcloths from the same lot shall be uniform in texture, softness and general appearance. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the specified acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Examination of the end item. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the classification of defects and AQL's set forth below. The lot size for the purpose of determining the sample size for examinations, shall be expressed in units of one individual washcloth.

4.2.1.1 Examination of the end item for defects in appearance and composition. The sample unit shall be one individual washcloth. Not more than three sample units shall be selected from one unit package.

Examine	Defects
Appearance	Material - not as specified. Break, cut or tear. Uneven or ragged edges. Spot or stain. Not lint free. Disagreeable odor

4.2.1.2 Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit shall be one individual washcloth.

Examine	Defects
Size	Less than specified.

4.2.1.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the following list. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot.

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Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Material	Any component missing. Any component damaged, affecting serviceability. Level not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of case liners, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of containers.

4.2.1.4 Examination of the item for count. Two packages shall be selected at random from each of the shipping containers selected in 4.2.1.3. The lot shall be unacceptable if the average count of towels per package of all packages examined is less than specified.

4.2.1.5 Inspection levels and AQL's for examination. The inspection levels and AQL's expressed in defects per 100 units, shall be as follows:

Examination Paragraph	Inspection Level	AQL
4.2.1.1	S-2	4.0
4.2.1.2	S-3	4.0
4.2.1.3	S-2	4.0

4.3 Testing of the end item. The methods of testing specified in table II shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in Section 3 apply to the results of the determinations made on a sample unit for test purposes, as specified in the applicable test method. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one washcloth and the inspection level for determining the sample size shall be S-1. The sample unit shall be 10 washcloths. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any test requirements specified.

TABLE II. Instructions for testing

Characteristic	Specification Reference Requirement	Test method	No. of determinations per sample unit	Results reported to the nearest
Weight, per sq. yd. (ounces)	table I	5041 1/	5	0.1 ounce
Bursting Strength dry (pounds)	table I	403 2/	10	1.0 pound
Bursting Strength wet (pounds)	table I	403 3/	10	1.0 pound
Absorption Total (percent)	table I	para. 4.4.2	5	1.0 percent
Rate (.1 milliliter) (seconds)	table I	432 2/	5	0.1 seconds
Blocking	table I	5872 1/	3	Scale rating

1/ Refers to Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191.
2/ Refers to Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Standards.
3/ See paragraph 4.4.1.

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4.4 Test Methods.

4.4.1 Bursting Strength (wet). To test the cloth for wet breaking strength, immerse the required specimens for test in a tray of clean water. Allow specimens to soak for a period of not less than 30 seconds or more than 60 seconds. Remove specimens and hang them by a corner for a period of not less than 5 or more than 7 minutes for drainage. Test specimens in accordance with TAPPI Test Method 403.

4.4.2 Absorption, water (total). Specimens, conditioned according to TAPPI T402, and measuring 4 inches by 4 inches ± 1/16 inch shall be weighed on an analytical balance. Immerse the specimens in water at 73°F. ± 2° for two minutes, then hang the specimens by the corner over water in a vessel having a tightly fitting cover; allow the specimens to drain for 1/2 hour; remove them and weigh the specimens in weighing bottles. Not less than five specimens shall be tested. The total percentage of water absorbed shall be calculated as follows:

$$\text{Basis, percent} = \frac{M-O}{O} \times 100$$

where O = weight of original conditioned specimen
M = weight of saturated specimen

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Washcloths, of like description, in quantities of 250, shall be bundled and wrapped in paper conforming to PPP-B-1055. The package shall be sealed with tape conforming to PPP-T-76.

5.1.2 Level B. Washcloths, of like description, in quantities of 250, shall be bundled and wrapped in paper conforming to UU-P-268. The package shall be sealed with tape conforming to PPP-T-76. Alternatively, the washcloths may be packaged in plastic wraps, heat sealed or sealed with tape.

5.1.3 Level C. Washcloths shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Washcloths, of like description, shall be packed in boxes conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3; PPP-B-591, class II; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; PPP-B-636, class weather resistant on PPP-B-640, class 2. The boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. The gross weight of the triple wall fiberboard box and the wood boxes shall not exceed approximately 200 pounds. The gross weight of the PPP-B-636 box shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Four packages of washcloths, of like description, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Washcloths shall be packed to afford adequate protection against physical and environmental damage during shipment, handling and limited storage. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification rules or National Motor Freight Classification rules, as applicable.

5.3 Standard Pack (civil agency procurements). The standard pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in paragraphs 5.1.2 and 5.2.2.

5.4 Marking. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 or MIL-STD-129, as applicable.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The washcloths covered by this specification are intended for one time use particularly under circumstances where cross contamination must be avoided.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Size (see 1.2.1).
(c) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Whether civil or military marking is required (see 5.3).

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 30 cents each.

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